

Standards for a TRRRS configuration for 3.5 mm connector were recently approved to add another conductor to the roster. This new conductor can be used for active noise cancellation, a second microphone for binaural recording or to connect an external power source.

## RCA

Close to the middle of 20th century, Radio Corporation of America came to a conclusion that a connection for high-fidelity content was needed. And thus they created the RCA connector. The cable is split into two or three ends, one for ground and the other(s) for the signal. The ends are colour coded for easy distinction. White for mono or left channel, red for right channel and yellow for composite video. The obvious disadvantage of using these is the absence of a balanced connection capabilities.

Originally intended for phonographs, RCA connectors have obviously gone through a number of uses. One can find them on record players, DVD players, televisions and DJ mixers. They're mostly on older gadgets, including older headphones. Because of lack of balanced signal support, they are more susceptible to noise and pose an issue in longer lines.

## XLR

A man named James H. Cannon invented XLR connectors which are called Cannon connectors. Having three or more pins on the male side, they were only intended for balanced connections. They started as Cannon X, then the addition of a latch made them XL connectors and finally when the female end was surrounded by synthetic rubber, they were declared as XLR. Though they were superficially similar to older DIN connectors, they weren't compatible. XLRs are an industry standard in balanced audio, found on almost all professional microphones, especially condenser microphones as they can easily produce phantom power. That's something a lot of condenser mics need. They were also widely used in loudspeakers until Speakon connectors took them down too. They are still used to move line-level signals to powered loudspeakers and are also found in some professional headphones and a lot of intercom systems.



XLR Connectors